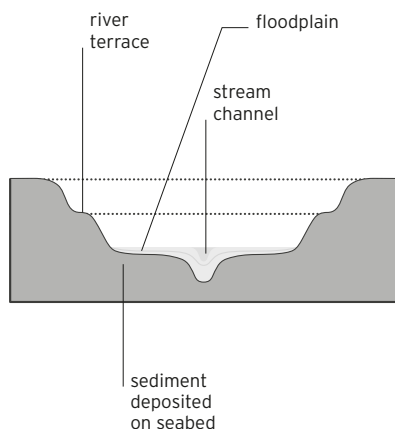


TERMINAL MORaine The ridge of silt, sand, or gravel that builds up at the snout (front end) of a glacier. It marks the maximum extent of the glacier's advance. See also *lateral moraine*, *medial moraine*, *moraine* (panel).



TERRACE ▲ A flat area in a river valley that is raised above the present floodplain. Terraces are remnants of former floodplains created when rivers flowed at a higher level. See also *floodplain*.

THERMAL METAMORPHISM The transformation of rocks brought about mainly by intense heat, rather than pressure. See also *contact metamorphism*, *dynamic metamorphism*.

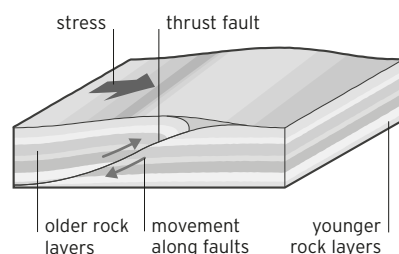
THERMOCLINE A region in an ocean, a lake, or the atmosphere where temperature changes more rapidly with depth or height.

THERMOHALINE A term describing the temperature and salt content of water. Together, these properties determine water's density and influence ocean currents.

THERMOPAUSE The upper edge of the thermosphere, about 400 miles (640 km) above Earth's surface and below the exosphere. See also *thermosphere*.

THERMOSPHERE The layer of the atmosphere between the mesosphere and the exosphere (the layer separating the atmosphere from space). It extends between about 50–400 miles (80–640 km) above Earth's surface.

THRUST FAULT ▼ A type of reverse fault, which is an angled fault where one side (the hanging wall) has been pushed up relative to the other side (the footwall). In a thrust fault, the angle of the dip is less than 45°. See also *fault* (panel), *reverse fault*.



THUNDERSTORM A storm with discharges of lightning and its acoustic effect, thunder. Thunderstorms are often associated with massive cumulonimbus clouds and characterized by heavy rain, hail, strong but localized winds, and occasionally tornadoes. See also *lightning*, *supercell cloud*.

TIDAL BORE A single large wave sometimes created when a rising tide enters a narrowing channel such as a river estuary. See also *estuary*.

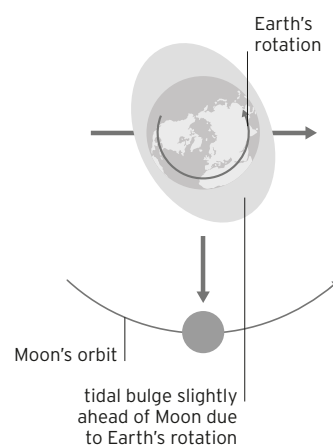
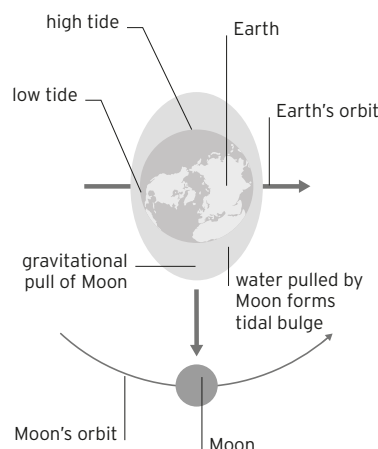
TIDAL FLAT An almost horizontal muddy or sandy area exposed at low tide and covered at high tide. Tidal flats are characteristic of sheltered areas such as estuaries. See also *estuary*.

TIDAL RACE A strong current created when a tide-generated water flow moves through a narrow channel.

TIDAL RANGE The vertical difference between a high tide and the succeeding low tide. At

any location, the tidal range varies according to the relative positions of the Sun and Moon.

TIDE ▼ The rise and fall (usually twice each day) of seawater on the shore caused by the gravitational pull of the Moon and the Sun and Earth's rotation. See also *neap tide*, *spring tide*, *tidal range*.



TILL A mixture of clay, sand, and rock fragments deposited by a glacier. Till that was left behind by glaciers in the last ice age covers many regions today. Also called boulder clay. See also *moraine* (panel).

TOMBOLO A spit that connects an island to the mainland. See also *spit*.

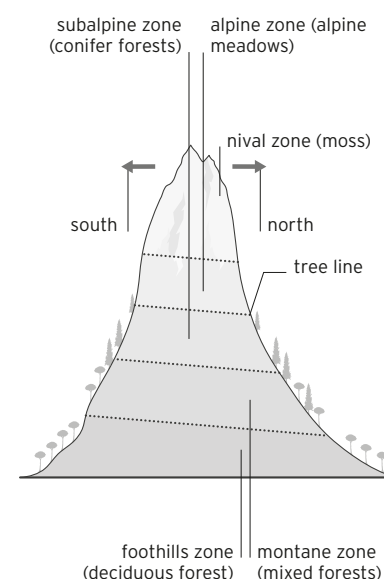
TORNADO A localized, violently destructive windstorm characterized by a tall funnel connecting a cloud with the ground. See *supercell cloud*.

TRANSFORM FAULT A type of fault in which two tectonic plates slide past each other. See also *boundary* (panel), *fault* (panel), *tectonic plate*.

TRANSPORT The movement of eroded and weathered material by water, ice, or wind. See also *weathering*, *erosion*.

TRAVERTINE A sedimentary rock, mostly calcium carbonate, that is precipitated around the edges of a hot spring. See also *precipitate*, *sedimentary rock*.

TREE LINE ▼ The altitude or latitude above which conditions are too harsh for trees to grow in a particular location.



TRENCH See *ocean trench*.

TRIBUTARY A river or stream that flows into a larger river.

TROPICAL Relating to those regions to the north and south of the equator, between the Tropic of Cancer (latitude 23.26°N) and the Tropic of Capricorn (latitude 23.26°S). See also *temperate*.

TROPICAL CYCLONE See *hurricane*.